

AI in the world of Education

A Reflexive Thematic Analysis of
YouTube Comments

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Dataset #1: Recap

How do people think AI influences education in ways that shape learning?

AI Expands Access to Learning

Education has always been unequal. Commenters believe AI could finally close that gap.

AI Changes the Emotional Experience of Learning

Good education should feel safe and non-judgmental. Commenters praised AI for removing shame and adapting to individual needs.

AI Changes How Students Think and Learn

Some see AI as a thinking partner. Others worry it removes the productive struggle that makes learning stick.

The **Problem** With One Side of the Story

Dataset #1 - hopeful reactions - people who already believed in AI

What do people on the other side believe?

A single dataset cannot answer a question about belief

I needed to find the people who felt threatened by AI, not just the ones who welcomed it



AI Will **Destroy Education, Teachers and Schools if we don't stop it**

303 comments — skeptical, critical, and often angry responses

803 comments across two opposing perspectives

Why the Research Question Had to **Change**

Original RQ

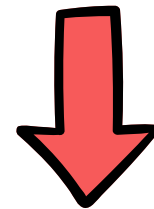
How do people think AI influences education in ways that shape learning?

Dataset #1

Hopeful Beliefs

Dataset #2

Threat Responses



When hopeful beliefs meet deep-seated fears, the clash reveals **what truly is at stake.**

Revised RQ

What do people's reactions to AI in education reveal about their underlying beliefs about learning, and what is at stake when those beliefs are threatened?

Three New Themes

The Education System Was Already Broken

"Within the system, hardly anyone cares about actually teaching or learning something. It's all just an oiled machine to produce non-thinking obedient wage slaves."

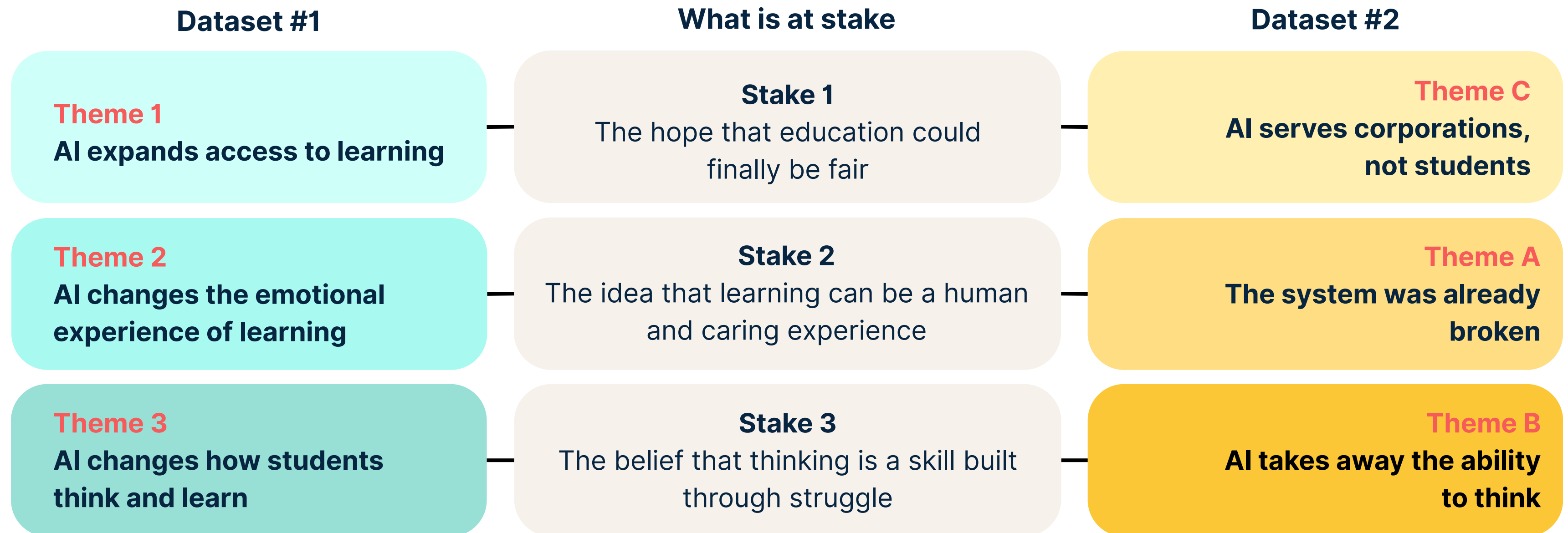
AI Takes Away the Ability to Think

"When our students do not understand what they are generating, they will not have a proper understanding of how to debug, build, or anything for that matter."

AI in Education Serves Corporations, Not Students

"Those who can afford the 'super educator 3000' model might have a chance of getting respectable education, further widening the inequality gap. Once you control education you control society."

How the Two Datasets Speak to Each Other



Conclusion: **So What?**

People's reactions to AI reveal what they believe learning is for.

Equal access

Emotional connection

The ability to think

**When AI threatens
those beliefs**

fear, grief, anger

**Everything people believed
education owed them is at stake**

Thank you.

Positionality

I am an immigrant student. No family here, no support system. I **manage everything alone**.

I have always been a **shy student**. AI gave me a space to ask questions I was too afraid to ask in a classroom.

I am **good at asking** precisely what I need from AI, and I **pay for the pro version**. What I get from AI is significantly more powerful than what someone on the free version receives.

I have 4 years in tech. I lived through the era when AI use was penalised, and the era where recruiters now actively look for people who use it well. I **adapted faster** than those who had been in the industry for decades.

I have **genuinely benefited** from AI, which makes me sympathetic to the hope. But I also sit on the more **privileged side** of the inequalities the second dataset warns about.